

It's black and mean-looking. But it is the technology inside that makes the Xbox an irresistible gaming console

Gaming enthusiasts have a lot to look forward to. The recently launched Microsoft Xbox proves that the PC components have entered the computer gaming world for the better.

Xbox is built around a collection of PC parts and runs DirectX8 on a stripped down Windows 2000 core, which means that game developers can get games for Xbox up and running quickly. What might bring even more gamers to Xbox initially is that it has enough features of both, a gaming console and a PC, to attract both the market segments.

The Xbox is feature-packed and state-of-the-art. The black box with the signature green Xbox 'jewel' positioned in its centre gives it an imposing profile. With an 8 GB hard drive (a first in any game console), it is now possible to 'save to disk' game-related information, as well as enable virtual memory that will speed up

the performance. You don't have to install games—they play off the disk. The controller's buttons and triggers are pressure-sensitive, and when you consider the two analog sticks plus a digital direction pad provided, you have plenty of control options. The hardware can push some serious numbers: 300 million pixels per second, 150 million transform and lighting polygons per second, and 100+ million shaded and textured polygons. Proprietary algorithms allow for a whopping 8:1 texture compression rate and four simultaneous textures per polygon. Not impressed? Well, how about Full Screen Anti-Aliasing (FSAA), DVD playback, HDTV support and a maximum resolution of 1920x1080? All this should translate into visual realism way beyond anything that has ever been seen in a gaming console before.

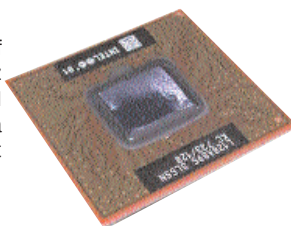
A sampler, if you want, can be seen in *Dead or Alive III* in which large, detailed characters make their way fighting through multi-tiered arenas. Visual effects such as the tracks left by the characters on the snow or the moving leaves in the forest with their rustling sound leave you spellbound. Another game, *Halo*, is reminiscent of first person shoot-outs such as *Quake*, and includes gameplay styles such



A versatile controller for enhanced flexibility

PRICE
CONSULT

A derivative of the 733 MHz Pentium III on the nVidia chipset



A 233 MHz GeForce3-class graphics processor



The 8 GB internal hard disk drive is a first for gaming consoles

